

Variable Name	Description	Source
id_city_istat_2009	Municipality identifier from ISTAT in year 2009	ISTAT
year	Year of election	Italian Minister for Internal Affairs
gender	Gender of the mayor	Italian Minister for Internal Affairs
age	Age of the mayor	Italian Minister for Internal Affairs
party_maj_left	Dummy indicating whether mayor's party is leftist	Italian Minister for Internal Affairs
party_maj_right	Dummy indicating whether mayor's party is rightist	Italian Minister for Internal Affairs
party_maj_center	Dummy indicating whether mayor's party is centrists	Italian Minister for Internal Affairs
term_limit	Dummy indicating whether the incumbent mayor is term limited	Italian Minister for Internal Affairs
years_school	Mayor's years of schooling	Italian Minister for Internal Affairs
empl_not	Dummy indicating whether mayor was unemployed before taking the mayorial office	Italian Minister for Internal Affairs
reelected	Dummy indicating whether incumbent mayor has been reelected for a second term	Italian Minister for Internal Affairs
recandidate	Dummy indicating whether incumbent mayor run for a second term	Italian Minister for Internal Affairs
avg_rev_collect	Average value of the speed of revenue collection in the electoral term	ANCI
avg_expend_speed	Average value of the speed of expenditure in the electoral term	ANCI
news_TOT	Total number of local news by newspapers (print+online)	Authors' computation (see Section I and Appendix B)
print_news_TOT	Total number of local news by local and national print newspapers	Authors' computation (see Section I and Appendix B)
web_TOT	Total number of local news from online editions of newspapers	Authors' computation (see Section I and Appendix B)
existing_news_TOT	Total number of local news by pre-existing newspapers (print+online)	Authors' computation (see Section I and Appendix B)
print_existing	Total number of local news by pre-existing print newspapers	Authors' computation (see Section I and Appendix B)
new_news_TOT	Total number of local news by new newspapers	Authors' computation (see Section I and Appendix B)

Variable Name	Description	Source
loc_TOT	Total number of local news by local newspapers (print+online)	Authors' computation (see Section I and Appendix B)
naz_TOT	Total number of local news by national newspapers (print+online)	Authors' computation (see Section I and Appendix B)
news_pure_TOT	Total number of local news by newspapers (excluding online editions enterering simultaenously to their own print newspaper)	Authors' computation (see Section I and Appendix B)
delta_log_comm	Difference new minus log ceased firms in comm sector	Istituto Tagliacarne
delta_log_finan	Diff log new minus log ceased firms in financial sector	Istituto Tagliacarne
logpop_res_tagliacarne	Log of resident population in the municipality in the year	Istituto Tagliacarne
log_unem	Log of the provincial unemployment rate	ISTAT
provincia_ADS	Name denomination of the province used by "Accertamenti Diffusioni Stampa" (ADS)	ADS
mean_entry_pc	Provincial weighted average of newspapers' entry per capita; weights correspond to the ratio of the municipal population over the provincial population	Authors' computation (see Section I and Appendix B)